

STARTER PACK

The South African **grocery** playbook.

Protein per rand, four store lists, six batch bases and a planner you can stick on the fridge. This is the reference the other three plans are built on — start here, then pick your rhythm.

4 store lists

Protein-per-rand table

6 batch bases

7-day planner

43g

PROTEIN PER R10 (BEST)

6

BATCH BASES

4

STORES COVERED

FIVE RULES THAT SURVIVE LOAD-SHEDDING, MONTH-END AND A TIGHT BUDGET

Shop for the week, not for the craving.

Every meal plan in this pack assumes the same five habits. Get these right and the specific recipes almost stop mattering — you'll be able to build a good week out of whatever the store actually has.

RULE 01

Anchor on protein first

Decide your protein for the week before anything else. Everything on the shelf is cheaper and easier — protein is the constraint, so it gets the first call on the budget.

RULE 02

Buy frozen without guilt

Frozen vegetables are picked and frozen at peak. They're cheaper, they don't rot in the drawer, and nutritionally they hold their own against fresh.

RULE 03

Two starches, not six

Rice and one other — potatoes, samp, pasta or bread. More variety means more half-used bags and more waste at the back of the cupboard.

RULE 04

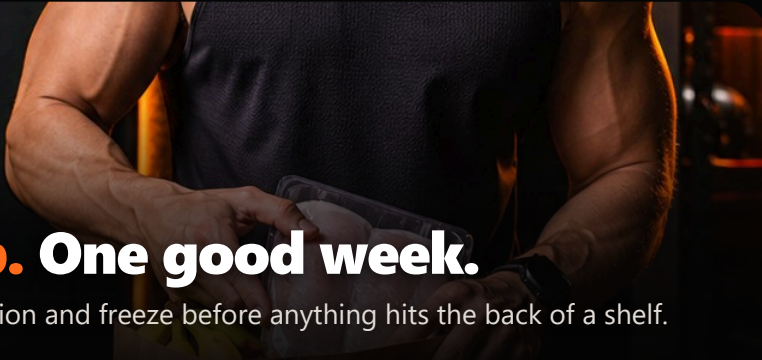
House brands by default

Oats are oats. Tinned tomato is tinned tomato. Save the brand loyalty for the two or three things you genuinely taste the difference in.

RULE 05 · THE ONE THAT SAVES THE MOST

Shop your fridge before you shop the store

Ten minutes with the fridge, freezer and cupboard before you write a list will cut a weekly shop noticeably. Most food waste in a South African home isn't food that spoiled — it's food that was bought twice.



One shop. One prep. One good week.

Unpack straight into the plan — wash, portion and freeze before anything hits the back of a shelf.

GRAMS OF PROTEIN PER R10 SPENT

Protein per rand.

This is the single table worth memorising. It doesn't say the top of the list is better food than the bottom — it says where your protein budget goes furthest when the month is long.

BEST VALUE**PROTEIN / R10**

Brown lentils, dry	±43 g
Sugar beans, dry	±42 g
Soya mince	±40 g
Tinned pilchards	±32 g
Chicken livers	±28 g
Chicken portions	±24 g
Peanut butter	±22 g

STILL WORTH IT**PROTEIN / R10**

Eggs	±20 g
Milk	±18 g
Chicken breast	±18 g
Tinned baked beans	±11 g
Lean beef mince	±10 g
Hake fillets	±10 g
Plain yoghurt	±7 g

HOW TO ACTUALLY USE IT**01** Build the base of the week from the left column**02** Spend the rest on what you look forward to eating**03** Mix plant and animal protein in the same meal**04** Tight month? Beans, lentils, eggs and livers carry it

Spend where it counts.

Protein first, vegetables second, and whatever's on special after that.

Estimated from typical South African shelf prices and raw or dry weights, rounded. Actual figures move with store, province, brand and week — treat the ranking as reliable and the exact numbers as a guide. Protein quality differs between sources; mixing plant and animal proteins across the day covers that comfortably.

SAME STRUCTURE, FOUR BUDGETS

Wherever you shop, the **shape** is the same.



Value week • ±R400

Protein	Eggs · chicken livers · sugar beans
Carbs	Rice · oats · brown bread
Produce	Cabbage · onions · frozen mixed veg
Extras	Stock cubes · curry powder · oil



Balanced week • ±R700

Protein	Chicken portions · tuna · eggs · lentils
Carbs	Brown rice · potatoes · wraps
Produce	Spinach · tomatoes · carrots · apples
Extras	Plain yoghurt · herbs · lemon



Lean week • ±R800

Protein	Chicken breast · hake · eggs · yoghurt
Carbs	Sweet potato · oats · brown rice
Produce	Greens · cucumber · berries · peppers
Extras	Olive oil · lemon · fresh herbs



Convenience week • ±R1 100

Protein	Chicken fillets · salmon · Greek yoghurt
Carbs	Microwave grains · sweet potato · seed bread
Produce	Prepped veg · salad bags · berries
Extras	Nuts · hummus · marinades

Trolley totals are rough weekly estimates for one person and will vary by store, province and week. FitSocial is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by any retailer shown — these lists simply show that the same plan works at every price point.

Four pots. **Twenty-two** servings.



6 SERVINGS

01

Freezer Savoury Mince

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
300 kcal	26 g	40 min

BUILD IT

1. Brown 1 onion and 2 carrots in oil, 5 minutes.
2. Add 500 g mince; break it up until no pink remains.
3. Stir in 1 tin tomato, a stock cube and herbs; simmer 20 minutes, then fold in 2 cups frozen veg for the last 5.

Becomes: rice bowls · wraps · cottage pie · pasta sauce



6 SERVINGS

02

Sugar Bean & Veg Curry

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
340 kcal	16 g	60 min

BUILD IT

1. Soak 500 g beans overnight, then simmer 50–60 minutes until soft.
2. Fry 1 onion, then 2 tbsp curry powder for 30 seconds.
3. Add carrots, 1 tin tomato and a stock cube; simmer 10 minutes, then stir in the beans and shredded cabbage for 10 more.

Becomes: curry & rice · jacket potato filling · wrap base



6 SERVINGS

03

Lentil & Butternut Stew

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
330 kcal	18 g	50 min

BUILD IT

1. Soften 1 onion and 2 carrots, then stir in 1 tbsp curry powder.
2. Add 2 cups lentils, 1 tin tomato, 2 stock cubes, bay and 4 cups water; simmer 25 minutes.
3. Add 500 g butternut; cook 15–20 more until it just holds shape.

Becomes: stew & samp · soup with extra water · rice topper



4 SERVINGS

04

Roast Chicken & Veg Tray

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
520 kcal	45 g	40 min

BUILD IT

1. Oven to 200°C. Toss chopped peppers, onion and courgette in oil and paprika; roast 22 minutes.
2. Season 800 g chicken breast; roast 20–24 minutes on a second tray.
3. Rest, slice, and box over rice with a squeeze of lemon.

Becomes: rice bowls · salads · wraps · pasta

Two more for the weeks you need speed.



BREAKFAST BASE

05

Chakalaka Egg & Veg Muffins

PER MUFFIN	PROTEIN	MAKES
180 kcal	16 g	12

YOU NEED

- 12 eggs
- 1 tin chakalaka (or 2 cups frozen veg)
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- Salt, pepper, pinch of chilli
- Oil for greasing

METHOD

1. Oven to 180°C; grease a 12-hole muffin tin well.
2. Whisk the eggs, then stir in the chakalaka, onion and seasoning.
3. Fill each hole about three-quarters.
4. Bake 20–22 minutes until set. Cool in the tin.

Storage: Freeze flat on a tray, then bag. 45 seconds in the microwave from frozen.



FASTEST PROTEIN

06

Peri-Peri Chicken Livers & Rice

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
400 kcal	34 g	3

YOU NEED

- 500 g chicken livers, trimmed
- 1 onion + 1 green pepper, sliced
- 1 tin chopped tomato
- 2 tsp peri-peri, 1 tsp paprika
- 1½ cups cooked rice

METHOD

1. Rinse the livers well and pat dry — this keeps the flavour mild.
2. Fry the onion and pepper 4 minutes; add the spices for 30 seconds.
3. Add the livers and sear 4–5 minutes, turning once.
4. Pour in the tomato and simmer 8 minutes. Serve over rice.

Storage: Best fresh — 25 minutes start to finish, so cook it on the night.

KEEP IT, DON'T BIN IT

How long things **actually** last.

Meal prep only saves money if the food gets eaten. Cool it fast, seal it cold, label the lid, and use the chart below instead of the smell test.

COOKED**FRIDGE FREEZER**

Rice & pasta	3 days	1 month
Mince, stews, curries	4 days	2 months
Chicken	3 days	2 months
Fish	2 days	don't refreeze
Egg muffins	4 days	2 months
Roast vegetables	4 days	not ideal

RAW & DRY**WHERE****HOW LONG**

Chicken, mince	Fridge	1–2 days
Eggs	Cool cupboard	3–4 weeks
Dry beans, lentils	Sealed jar	1 year+
Oats, rice	Sealed jar	6–12 months
Peanut butter	Cupboard	3 months open
Frozen veg	Freezer	12 months

FOUR NON-NEGOTIABLES**01** Cool uncovered, seal within 2 hours**02** Thaw in the fridge, never on the counter**03** Reheat once, right through, then eat it**04** Label every lid with the dish and the date**<2 hrs****COOL BEFORE
SEALING****0–5°C****FRIDGE****–18°C****FREEZER****Once****REHEAT LIMIT**

General food-safety guidance for home kitchens. When in doubt, throw it out — a wasted portion costs far less than a bad week.

STICK IT ON THE FRIDGE

Your **seven-day** planner.

	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER	SNACK / TRAINING
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Saturday				
Sunday				

THIS WEEK'S BASES

PREP DAY & TIME

ONE THING TO IMPROVE

PAPER PLANNER, MEET THE REAL ONE

Stop rewriting the **same list.**

FitSocial builds your South African grocery plan, tracks the meals and macros against it, and logs the training on the other side of the equation — so next week starts from what actually happened, not from a blank page.



Scan to get early access

fitsocial.co.za

FitSocial launches on Android and iOS. Join the waitlist to get your invite before the public launch — founding members get free early access, locked-in founding pricing and a say in the roadmap.

- ✓ Log meals and macros in seconds
- ✓ Track workouts, runs and streaks
- ✓ Share progress with your circle
- ✓ Build South African grocery plans
- ✓ See weekly trends, not single days
- ✓ Free core logging, always